

Jack Hambrick, MFT (M.2300265)
Hambrick Psychotherapy LLC
1051 Old Henderson Rd., Columbus, OH 43220

Informed Consent for Psychotherapy

Our time in therapy is a consensual agreement but it is also a contractual agreement. It is important for us to have a clear understanding about how our therapeutic relationship will work, and what each of us can expect. This consent will provide a clear framework for our work together. Feel free to discuss any of this with me. Please read and indicate that you have reviewed this information and agree to it by acknowledging your agreement at the end of the document.

The Therapeutic Process

You have already taken the first step toward feeling better in deciding to seek therapy and scheduling your first appointment. The outcome of your treatment depends largely on your willingness to engage in this process, which may, at times, result in considerable discomfort. Remembering unpleasant events and becoming aware of feelings attached to those events can bring on strong feelings of anger, depression, anxiety, etc. There is no miracle cure. I cannot promise that your behavior or circumstance will change. I can promise to support you and do my best to understand you and repeating patterns, as well as help you clarify what it is that you want for yourself.

Confidentiality

The session content and all relevant materials to the client's treatment will be held confidential unless the client requests in writing to have all or portions of such content released to a specifically named person/ persons/ entities. Limitations of such client held privilege of confidentiality exists and are itemized below:

- 1 If a client threatens or makes a suicide attempt or otherwise conducts themselves in a way there is a substantial risk of incurring serious bodily harm.
- 2 If a client threatens grave bodily harm or death to another person (Tarasoff Duty).
- 3 Suspicions of abuse or neglect in the case of an elderly person, disabled person, or person under the age of 18.
- 4 If a client is in therapy or being treated by order of a court of law, or if the information is obtained for the purpose of giving an expert's report to an attorney.

- 5 If a judge in a court of law compels the therapist to make testimony via court ordered subpoena.
- 6 When attempting to collect on amounts owed to Jack Hambrick or Hambrick Psychotherapy LLC.

If we see each other accidentally outside of the therapy office, I will not acknowledge you first. Your right to privacy and confidentiality is of the utmost importance to me, and I do not wish to jeopardize your privacy. However, if you acknowledge me first, I will be more than happy to speak briefly with you but feel it appropriate not to engage in any lengthy discussions in public or outside of the therapy office.

Limits of Confidentiality for Families/ Couples/ Relationships

I view the family/ couple/ relationship as the “client.” In order for treatment-related information about the family/couple to begin, signed informed consent is required by all parties.

In order for treatment-related information regarding the family/ couple/ relationship to be released a written consent form must be signed by all parties.

During treatment of a family/couple, Jack abides by additional limitations to confidentiality—described as a No-Secrets Policy. This policy means that information learned in an individual session with one member of a family/couple may potentially be shared with the family/couple as part of the treatment process. This policy is to help therapists treat the entire family/couple while preventing conflicts of interest between parties. Therapists will exercise clinical judgment regarding the need to bring information gained elsewhere into family/couple sessions.

Risks and Benefits

Psychotherapy has both benefits and risks. Risks may include experiencing uncomfortable feelings, such as sadness, guilt, anxiety, anger, frustration, loneliness and helplessness, because the process of psychotherapy often requires discussing the unpleasant aspects of your life. However, psychotherapy has been shown to have benefits for couples and individuals who undertake it. Therapy often leads to a significant reduction in feelings of distress, increased satisfaction in interpersonal relationships, greater personal awareness and insight, increased skills for managing stress and resolutions to specific problems. There are no guarantees about what will happen. Psychotherapy requires a very active effort on your part. In order to be most successful, you will have to work on things we discuss outside of sessions.

Up to the first three sessions will involve my evaluation of your needs, this will be our introductory period. By the end of the evaluation, I will be able to offer you some initial

impressions and ideas of what our work might include. I am open to your suggestions as well, but it is my goal to establish a treatment plan which we can both feel confident with moving forward. You should evaluate this information and make your own assessment about whether you feel comfortable working with me. I will do my best to give you a general sense of my communication and style of therapy. At that point, we will review your goals for therapy and how you feel about our match. If you have questions about my procedures, we should discuss them whenever they arise. If your doubts persist and you feel that we are not a good match, I will be happy to refer you to another mental health professional for treatment.

About Jack

Jack Hambrick has been approved by the State of Ohio Counselor, Social Work and Marriage and Family Therapist Board as a Marriage and Family Therapist (M.2300265). Jack is a graduate of the University of Akron's master's program in Marriage and Family Therapy and Counseling. He holds a bachelor's degree in journalism from West Virginia University.

Appointments and Fees

Initial 90-min Intake session: \$250

90-minute session: \$240

50-minute session: \$160

Returned/Bounced Payment: \$45

*If the amount due is not satisfied within 7 calendar days an additional \$50 will be assessed to your account balance.

No Call/No Show or cancellations less than 24 hours before the session start time: Full session fee is due and automatically billed to the credit card on file.

All balances must be zero to schedule or maintain additional scheduled appointments.

**No Call/No Show, last-minute cancellation, returned check, or documentation fees are client responsibility.

If you need to cancel or reschedule your appointment, please do so with more than 24 hours' notice.

We do not offer refunds for any reason. If your payment is returned by the bank for any reason (NSF, credit card chargeback/dispute, etc.) you will be responsible for the amount owed and the returned payment fee of \$45.

If a balance remains unpaid, we will try to contact you through multiple means including mail, email, or text. We reserve the right to waive confidentiality if your account is past due and we are attempting to collect on a debt. We also reserve the right to refer your account to collections.

Documentation/ Letters

In addition to weekly appointments, it is my practice to charge this amount on a prorated basis for other professional services that you may require such as: report writing, telephone conversations that last longer than 10 minutes, attendance at meetings or consultations which you have requested, or the time required to perform any other service which you may request of me.

Court

If you anticipate becoming involved in a court case, I recommend that we discuss this fully before you waive your right to confidentiality (also known as waiving your privilege). The fee for court appearances is \$500 per hour with the first hour billed automatically even if the time spent is any less than an hour. 50% of any court related fees would need to be paid before the court appearance based on the time requirement I anticipate. If your case requires my participation, you will be expected to pay for the professional time required even if another party compels me to testify.

Emails

I will do my best to answer your email in 72 hours. Please keep all emails to scheduling issues only. I cannot guarantee confidentiality of emails. It is recommended that you use the client portal to reach me. If you email regarding something outside of scheduling, I may not respond and may choose to wait to discuss the email with you in session. Excessive use of emails will fall under the prorated bill rate of \$140 for use of clinician time for response. Emails will become part of your clinical record.

Texting

I do not conduct therapy through text messages. Texts are to be used for scheduling issues only. Any other attempt for discussion beyond scheduling will not be answered. I will only answer texts during business hours. Immediate concerns need to be directed to the office. Excessive use of texts will fall under phone call policy of prorated rate of \$140 an hour. Texts will become part of your clinical record.

Sessions

For Individuals and Couples sessions will ordinarily be 45-50 minutes in duration, for Families sessions are 65 minutes in duration. Sessions are once per week at a time we agree on,

although sessions may be more frequent. The time scheduled for your appointment is assigned to you and you alone. If you need to cancel or reschedule a session, I ask that you provide me with 24 hour notice. If you miss a session without canceling, or cancel with less than the required notice, I will charge you a missed session fee in the amount of your regular fee. If you are late, your appointment will still need to end on time. If you are more than 15 minutes late and do not notify me, it will count as a missed session and I will not be able to see you.

Recording of Sessions

With your consent, I may audio or video record sessions solely for the purpose of clinical note-taking and documentation. Recordings are used only to assist with accurate record-keeping of our work together and are not shared with any third parties except as required by law or as described in the Confidentiality section above. Recordings are stored securely and are subject to the same confidentiality protections as all other clinical records. By signing this agreement, you consent to the possibility of session recording for this purpose. You have the right to withdraw this consent at any time by notifying me in writing.

Professional Records

I am required to keep appropriate records of the psychological services that I provide. Your records are maintained in a secure location in the office. Except in unusual circumstances that involve danger to yourself, you have the right to a copy of your file. Because these are professional records, they may be misinterpreted and/or upsetting to untrained readers. For this reason, I recommend that you initially review them with me, or have them forwarded to another mental health professional to discuss the contents. If I refuse your request for access to your records, you have a right to have my decision reviewed by another mental health professional, which I will discuss with you upon your request. You also have the right to request that a copy of your file be made available to any other health care provider at your written request.

Contact

You may feel free to contact me between sessions but be aware: Due to the nature of my work as a psychotherapist, I am not immediately available by telephone. You may leave a message on my voice mail and I will return your call as soon as possible, but it may take up to two business days for non-urgent matters.

Phone calls, texts, and emails should be reserved for scheduling, billing and payment questions, or notifying me that you will be late or are canceling a session. Phone sessions must be scheduled in advance, just as we would schedule an in-person session.

If you are experiencing an emergency, call 911 or go to the nearest emergency room.

Other Rights

If you are unhappy with what is happening in therapy, I hope you will talk with me so that I can respond to your concerns. Such comments will be taken seriously and handled with care and respect. You may also request that I refer you to another therapist and are free to end therapy at any time.

You have the right to considerate, safe and respectful care, without discrimination as to race, ethnicity, color, gender, sexual orientation, age, religion, national origin, or source of payment.

You have the right to ask questions about any aspects of therapy and about my specific training and experience. You have the right to expect that I will not have social or sexual relationships with patients or with former patients.

Consent for Treatment

Your signature below indicates that you have read this Agreement [OPTIONAL: and the Notice of Privacy Practices] and agree to the terms.

Date

Signature of Patient or Personal Representative

Printed Name of Patient or Personal Representative Description of Personal Representative's Authority